IMPORTANT DOCUMENTS CHECKLIST

The papers you'd need to prove who you are, what you own and what you're owed, and where each one is kept.

DOCUMENT DC-05
SERIES DOCUMENTS
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STATUS PUBLIC ISSUE

GUIDE / VERIFY: A household record. Keep completed copies somewhere safe: they may hold personal information. **Review and update at least once a year, and whenever something changes.**

After a disaster, people need documents to get aid, file insurance claims, get prescriptions and go back to work, often at the same time they've lost their homes. Keep originals safe, and keep copies somewhere else.

1. HOW TO KEEP THEM

- **Originals:** a fire- and water-resistant box or safe at home, or a bank safe-deposit box (not reachable after hours or when the bank is closed).
- **Paper copies:** in a waterproof pouch in your go-bag.
- **Digital copies:** scanned or photographed, in an encrypted drive or a secure, password-protected cloud account.
- Give copies of key papers (wills, powers of attorney) to someone you trust.

2. CHECKLIST

Mark O = original, C = paper copy, D = digital copy. Note where each is kept.

DOCUMENT	O	C	D	WHERE KEPT
IDENTITY				
Driver's licenses / state IDs				
Birth certificates				
Social Security cards				
Passports; citizenship, naturalization or immigration papers				
Marriage, divorce, custody and adoption papers				
Military service records (DD-214)				
HOUSEHOLD AND PROPERTY				
Deed, mortgage papers or lease				
Insurance policies (home, flood, auto, life, health)				
Vehicle titles and registrations				
Home inventory (photos / video) and receipts for valuables				
MONEY				
Bank, credit card and loan account list (institution and phone, no PINs)				
Recent tax returns (2 to 3 years)				

Pay stubs; benefits statements (Social Security, pension, disability)				
Retirement and investment account statements				
HEALTH				
Health insurance and prescription cards (front and back)				
Medical Information Sheet for each person *(DC-04)*				
Immunization records				
Pet vaccination and microchip records				
LEGAL				
Wills and trusts				
Powers of attorney (financial and health care)				
Advance directives / living wills				
ALSO				
Recent photos of each family member and pet (for identification)				
Emergency Contact Sheet and Family Emergency Plan *(DC-01, DC-02)*				
Other:				

LAST REVIEWED: _____ NEXT REVIEW: _____

SOURCES / FURTHER REFERENCE

1. FEMA / Consumer Financial Protection Bureau: Emergency Financial First Aid Kit (EFFAK). `ready.gov/financial-preparedness`
2. FEMA: Ready.gov: Safeguard Critical Documents and Valuables. `ready.gov`
3. Federal Trade Commission: Protecting personal information. `consumer.ftc.gov`

IMPORTANT: Copies of identity documents can be misused if lost. Keep them secure, and shred old copies when you replace them.